CHAPTER 2: SOCIOLOGY AS SCIENCE

A) SCIENCE, SCIENTIFIC METHODS AND CRITIQUE

YEAR	PAPER	Q.NO	MARKS	QUESTION STATEMENT
2025	I	6(a)	20	What is science? Do you think that the methods used in natural sciences can be applied to sociology? Give reasons for your answer [cite: 15].
2023	I	5(a)	10	Examine the relevance of corporate social responsibility in a world marked by increasing environmental crises [cite: 15].
2023	I	3(a)	20	What are the characteristics of scientific method? Do you think that scientific method in conducting sociological research is foolproof? Elaborate [cite: 15].
2022	I	1(b)	10	How does a researcher achieve objectivity in interpretative research? [cite: 15]
2018	I	5(c)	10	Does scientific method make Sociology a science? Illustrate your answer with Durkheim's method [cite: 15].
2016	I	3(b)	20	Describe the basic postulates of Scientific method. How far are these followed in sociological research? [cite: 15]
2015	I	1(a)	10	Is Sociology a science? Give reasons for your answer [cite: 15].
2015	I	1(b)	10	Discuss the relevance of historical method in the study of Society? [cite: 15]

B) MAJOR THEORETICAL STRANDS OF RESEARCH METHODOLOGY

YEAR	PAPER	Q.NO	MARKS	QUESTION STATEMENT
2025	I	2(a)	20	What is positivism? Critically analyze the major arguments against it [cite: 15].
2020	I	1(c)	10	Methodology is a system of rules, principles and procedures, which forms scientific investigation. Comment [cite: 15].
2018	I	6(c)	20	In what way 'Interpretative' method is different from the 'positivist' approach in the study of social phenomena? Explain with examples, the explanatory and exploratory designs of social research [cite: 15].
2017	I	2(c)	10	In what way is 'Interpretative' method different from the 'positivist' approach in the study of social phenomena? [cite: 15]

C) POSITIVISM AND ITS CRITIQUE

YEAR	PAPER	Q.NO	MARKS	QUESTION STATEMENT
2022	I	3(a)	20	What are the shortfalls of positivist philosophy that gave rise to the non-positivist methods of studying social reality? [cite: 15]
2020	I	7(b)	20	Phenomenological perspectives in Sociology reject many of the assumption of positivism, Comment [cite: 15].
2017	I	2(b)	20	Examine the basic postulates of positivism and post-positivism [cite: 15].
2017	I	1(b)	10	Explain ethnomethodological and phenomenological perspectives as critique of positivism [cite: 15].
2013	I	1(c)	10	Critically examine positivistic approach in sociology studies [cite: 15].

D) FACT VALUE AND OBJECTIVITY

YEAR	PAPER	Q.NO	MARKS	QUESTION STATEMENT
2026	I	5(a)	10	The major challenge for sociology researchers is to analyze social reality objectively. Critically analyze [cite: 15].
2024	I	2(b)	20	Do you think 'objectivity' is an over-hyped idea in sociological research? Discuss the merits and demerits of non-positivist methods [cite: 15].
2020	I	1(b)	10	Is Sociology a Value-free Science? Discuss [cite: 15, 16].
2016	I	1(b)	10	What is 'Value free Sociology'? Clarify [cite: 16].
2014	I	1(a)	10	How is objectivity different from value neutrality? Discuss with reference to Weber's views on methodology [cite: 16].

E) NON-POSITIVIST METHODOLOGIES

YEAR	PAPER	Q.NO	MARKS	QUESTION STATEMENT
2026	I	5(d)	10	Explain the concept of 'definition of the situation' and its significance in sociology [cite: 16].
2026	I	3(b)	20	Is 'interpretativism' more effective than 'positivism' in analysing social reality? Discuss [cite: 16].
2021	I	1(b)	10	Do you think ethnomethodology helps us in getting reliable and valid data? Justify your answer [cite: 16].
2021	I	2(b)	20	How far are sociologists justified in using positivist approach to understand social reality? Explain with suitable illustrations [cite: 16].
2018	I	2(a)	20	Is non-positivism methodology scientific? Illustrate [cite: 16].
2015	I	4(a)	20	“Non positivistic methodology is essential for understanding human behavior.” Discuss [cite: 16].